won an MLA election from Hubli Rural in 1994 and has been the BJP's candidate from that seat ever since, summed up this political bump for Network18: '10,000 votes was our vote bank in Hubli before 1994 in 1989 and 1985. I got 46,000 votes in 1994.'[63]

The Idgah controversy was finally put to rest politically by H.D. Deve Gowda when he was chief minister in 1995. After an all-party meeting, he persuaded the AeI itself to hoist the national flag at the maidan. Yediyurappa had threatened a dharna with all forty BJP MLAs and a state-wide Hubli-chalo agitation if the issue was not resolved,[64] so Gowda's was a prudent solution. The Ram Temple issue did not cut it for the BJP in Karnataka, but the Idgah movement's appeal, melding a dispute over a religious space with the national tricolour and patriotic sentiments, successfully turned it into the 'Ayodhya of the south',[65] albeit at a much lower temperature. Legally, the case reached its denouement in 2010, when a two-member bench of the Supreme Court upheld the orders of the lower courts and ordered the demolition of the AeI structure. The apex court also ruled that the ground was the exclusive property of the HDMC, with the AeI having the right to conduct prayers twice a year.[66]

The Idgah Maidan movement was not an aberration. In the coastal town of Chikkamagaluru, the BJP has been involved in a similar political mobilisation around a disputed religious site—the Sree Guru Dattatreya Bababudan Swamy Dargah on the Bababudangiri Hill. For decades, the site has been a syncretic shrine. Hindus consider it the final resting place of Dattatreya, considered an incarnation of Vishnu, Shiva and Brahma, while Muslims believe that the dargah is one of the earliest centres of Sufism in India, with Sufi saint Dada Hayat Mir Qalandar having lived there for years. In the late 1980s, the BJP, VHP and RSS cadres started demanding that the shrine be declared a Hindu temple. 'Prior to 1964, the shrine Shree Guru Dattatreya Bababudan Swamy Dargah was a symbol of religious harmony, where both Hindus and Muslims offered prayers at the same shrine.'[67] The area became disputed in 1964 when it was allotted to the Waqf Board by the Karnataka government. When local Hindus went to court, a district